

One such fan, a devoted member of the Danni Wyatt-Hodge faithful, had travelled all the way from Mumbai to watch his favourite player in action. His poster read, 'Danni, watching you from the stadium is always a treat to my eyes.'

Then came the match. The Diary silently prayed it wouldn't go to a Super Over, and thankfully, the cricketing gods obliged. The report was filed, the press conferences attended. Now came the challenge of finding an auto back to the hotel.

After exchanging goodbyes and with no auto in sight, the Diary plugged in its earphones and began the walk back to the hotel. It was then that it dawned — the nerves had settled, and the WPL season had truly arrived in Bengaluru.

## Cricket, chaos and culinary delights

A local described Vadodara as a city that wakes up *aaram se* (leisurely), easing into the day with a wholesome breakfast before truly getting to work around noon.

[illegible]

Another chance to explore came on the final evening, after the conclusion of the Women's Premier League (WPL) inaugural leg, in the company of an old colleague.

Situated on the outskirts of the city, the BCA Stadium in Kotambi was tasked with hosting the much-anticipated third edition of the WPL. Glorious sunsets painted the stadium in hues of orange, much like the locals who turned up in their team's colours. The absence of Gujarat Giants on the fixture list that day didn't dampen spirits — fans still turned out in huge numbers, eager to witness some of the world's best in action. Vadodara deserves more cricket — its people, and the Diary, would certainly agree. And Kotambi is ready for it!

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